

Hanna SisteK

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Academic Appointments

2026-2027	Postdoctoral Research & Design Studio Fellow (Incoming) Edmond and Safra Center for Ethics <i>Harvard University, Cambridge, MA</i>
2026-	Research Affiliate Student Perspectives on AI Research & Knowledge Lab (SPARK) <i>John Martinson Honors College, Purdue University, West Lafayette, IN</i>
2025-2026	Postdoctoral Fellow Center for American Political History, Media, and Technology (CAPT) & Governance and Responsible AI Lab (GRAIL) <i>Purdue University, West Lafayette, IN</i>

Education

2025	Ph.D. Political Science <i>Purdue University, West Lafayette, IN</i> Major field: <i>Comparative Politics</i> Minor fields: <i>International Relations, Political Methodology</i> Dissertation: <i>Structural Incentives for Politicians to Manipulate Domestic Opinion</i> Committee Members: <i>Cherie D. Maestas (chair), Andy Baker, Mollie Cohen, Marcus Mann</i>
2021	M.A. Political Science <i>Purdue University, West Lafayette, IN</i>
2005	Journalism degree <i>Gothenburg University, Sweden</i>
2003	B.S. Physical Therapy <i>Lund University, Sweden</i>

Peer-Reviewed Publications

* indicates a graduate student co-author

- I. Hannah, Matthew, Jennifer Hoewe, **Hanna SisteK**, Taeik Kim*, and Dan Goldwasser. 2024. "[A mindfulness-based information literacy framework for the current information environment.](#)" *Journal of Information Literacy*, 18(2).
[Named a Top 20 Article of 2024 by the Library Instruction Round Table of the American Library Association]

Working Papers

- I. | “Escalating Political Use of Disinformation: A New Reputational Theory Explaining Communication Changes in Democracies” *Under Review*.
2. | “Asymmetric Behavioral Shifts in Political Use of Disinformation: Case Study Interview Evidence From Europe”
3. | “Asymmetric Accountability: Affective Polarization and Public Responses to Political Disinformation”.

Works in Progress

- I. | “Using Large Language Models to practice cross-partisan dialogue” with Nebras Alam, Netra Joshi, Sarrah Zojwalla and Vipula Shirse.
2. | “Public Justifications of Political Disinformation in the United States: Comparing Topic Modeling, Manual Coding, and Generative AI Classification” with Normand Péladeau.
3. | “AI as a Tool Against Partisan Disinformation”
4. | “The Effect of Disinformation on Twittersphere Sentiment – Not Much When Debunked”.

Research Software & Digital Projects

- I. | [ConvoLab](#): Human-AI interaction application designed to let users practice having difficult political conversations with people they disagree with, using two AI agents.
Repository: <https://github.com/GRAIL-center/ConvoLab>

Public Engagement

- I. | [CAPTivated Podcast](#), Center for American Political History, Media, and Technology, Purdue University. Released February 5, 2026; new episodes biweekly. *Co-founder, Co-host, and Co-producer*.

Fellowships, Grants, and Awards

External

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| 2024 | | Rapoport Doctoral Dissertation Grant. \$15,000 |
| 2024 | | SPARK Award. APSA Political Communication Section. \$750 |
| 2024 | | Peter Mair Travel Award. APSA European Politics and Society Section. \$300 |
| 2024 | | Prestage-Cook Award. Southern Political Science Association. \$300 |
| 2016 | | Innovation in Development Reporting Grant, European Journalism Centre.
Project: The Price of Basmati. €18,510 |

2012		Language Studies Grant (Arabic, in Cairo), Swedish Journalist Union. \$1,800
2008		Innovation Journalism Fellow, H-STAR Institute, Stanford University (Vinnova)

Selected Internal

2025-2022		Purdue University: Postdoctoral Supplemental Travel Award; Graduate Peer Reviewed Article Award; Graduate Grant Submission Award (multiple years); Promise Travel Grant; Institute for Information Literacy. <i>Total: \$2,500</i>
2024, 2020		Summer Research Grants (Purdue Graduate School, Purdue Research Foundation) <i>Total: \$10,400</i>
2024		Outstanding Teaching Assistant. Departmental award.
2023		Teaching Assistant of the Year. Award by Pi Sigma Alpha, Purdue University

Invited Talks

February 2026		"Using AI as a Research Assistant". Guest Lecture for COMM 140: Fundamentals of Media Communication, College of Liberal Arts and Sciences at University of Illinois Chicago
February 2026		"Using AI to ask Historical Questions". Workshop with Aaron Mendon-Plasek for the History Department, Purdue University
October 2025		"Navigating Political Violence News in the Digital Age". Center for C-SPAN Scholarship & Engagement (CCSE), Purdue University
October 2025		"Behind the Headlines". Joint seminar presentation with Sage Goodwin. Center for American Political History, Media, and Technology, Purdue University

Conference Presentations

PolComm		2025 APSA Political Communication Preconference
RMCEPS		2025 (poster) Rebecca B. Morton Conference on Experimental Political Science, New York University
ISA		2025
SPSA		2025, 2026
APSA		2025, 2024, 2023
MPSA		2025, 2024, 2023, 2022
WPSA		2023
ICTS		2023 International Conspiracy Theory Symposium, University of Miami

Teaching and Research Experience

Instructor of Record

Summer 22/23		POL 130 - Introduction to International Relations
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Research Assistant

AY 2018/19		Editorial Assistant for <i>Politics, Groups, and Identities</i> .
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Teaching Assistant: Graduate level

Fa 24/Sp. 25		SCLA 521 - Societal Impacts of AI
Fa 24/Sp 25		SCLA 522 - Artificial Intelligence Policy, Governance, and Ethics

Teaching Assistant: Undergraduate level

Fa 23, Sp 24		POL 223 - Introduction to Environmental Policy and Politics
Fa 22, Sp 22, Sp 23		POL 327 - Global Green Politics
Fall 2022		POL 323 - Comparative Environmental Policy and Politics
Fall 2021		POL 141 - Introduction to Comparative Politics
Fall 2021		POL 323 - Renewable Energy Politics Around the World
Spring 2021		SCLA 102 - Cornerstone class on Transformative texts, Critical Thinking & Oral Communication II: Modern World “Democracy, Citizenship and Civic Duty”
Fall 2021		SCLA 102 - Cornerstone class on Transformative texts, Critical Thinking and Oral Communication II: “Technology, Great Power, and Its Responsibilities”
Spring 2020		POL 237 - Introduction to U.S. Foreign Policy
Fall 2019		POL 130 - Introduction to International Relations

Selected Additional Training

January, 2026		AI-Assisted Qualitative Research <i>Trena Paulus/KiND Institute, New Orleans</i>
January, 2026		Experiments in the Social Sciences <i>Donald Green/KiND Institute, New Orleans</i>
September, 2025		Temporal ERGM for Network Panel Data <i>Scott Duxbury, UNC/The Methodology Center at Purdue</i>
April, 2025		Generative AI for Survey Research: Principles and Applications <i>The New York Chapter of the American Association for Public Opinion Research Webinar</i>

April, 2025	Writing Policy Briefs and Op-Eds Communicating Research with Policymakers and Community <i>International Studies Association Webinar</i>
April, 2025	Demystifying the Automated Analysis of Open-Ended Survey Responses <i>American Association for Public Opinion Research Webinar</i>
February, 2025	Supervision in Machine Learning <i>Workshop, Graduate Professional Development, Purdue University</i>
January, 2025	Foundations in Machine Learning <i>KiND Institute/SPSA workshop, Puerto Rico</i>
January, 2025	Data Coding in Qualitative Research <i>KiND Institute/SPSA workshop, Puerto Rico</i>
November, 2024	The AI Imperative: Purdue-Google AI Summit <i>Hyatt Regency, Indianapolis</i>
Fall 2023	Qualitative In-depth Interview Method: A Quality Approach to Data Collection and Analysis Setup <i>American Association for Public Opinion Research Short Course</i>
Fall 2023	Interpretive Process Tracing & Practice Tracing <i>APSA Short Course</i>

Pedagogical Training

Summer 2022	Certificate in Foundations of College Teaching <i>Foundations of College Teaching Purdue University</i>
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Languages and Skills

Languages: Swedish and Czech (native); English (fluent); German (intermediate); French and Arabic (basic)

Software: R, Python, Git, $\text{\LaTeX}$, Qualtrics, NVivo, Docker

Learning Management Systems: Blackboard, Brightspace

Service

Department

AY 2023/24 Spring 2025	Political Science Research Collaboratory <i>Mentored undergraduate research assistants on comparative research about media systems, academic writing and survey research. Purdue University</i>
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Committees

2025-2026	Summit Co-Organizer "Staying Informed in the Age of AI and Algorithms" <i>Public summit in Indianapolis organized by CAPT/GRAIL, bringing together thought leaders, educators, policymakers and scholars to discuss the impact of AI and algorithms on our media ecosystem. The event will pair educational workshops with community partners and feature moderated panels and public discussions.</i>
2025-2026	Expert Participant, Information Intelligence Working Group <i>Interdisciplinary development of an "information intelligence" program for youth and civic organizations.</i>

Discipline

2025	Polarization Consortium Workshop <i>Discussant</i>
2025	APSA <i>Chair</i>
2025	SPSA <i>Discussant and Chair</i>
2024	National Institute of Standards and Technology AI Safety Institute Consortium <i>Member of Working Group on Synthetic Content</i>
2023	APSA, MPSA, WPSA <i>Discussant</i>

Relevant Non-academic work experience

Reporter & Staff Writer

2004-2018	Freelance <i>Based in India, Egypt and Silicon Valley. Reporting from 19 countries for over 100 outlets.</i>
Summer 2017	Etc Göteborg <i>Gothenburg, Sweden</i>
Summer 2016	KIT <i>Stockholm, Sweden</i>
Spring 2008	CNET News <i>San Francisco, U.S.</i>
Summer 2007	Dagens Industri <i>Stockholm, Sweden</i>
Summer 2006	Göteborgs-Posten <i>Gothenburg, Sweden</i>
Spring 2006	Veckans Affärer <i>Stockholm, Sweden</i>

Memberships

American Political Science Association, Midwest Political Science Association, International Studies Association, Southern Political Science Association, American Association for Public Opinion Research

References

Cherie D. Maestas	Associate Dean of Research, Innovation, and Graduate Education, College of Liberal Arts, Professor of Political Science, Purdue University. cmaestas@purdue.edu. Dissertation Chair.
Kathryn Cramer Brownell	Professor in History, and Director of Center for American Political History, Media, and Technology, Purdue University. brownell@purdue.edu. Postdoctoral Supervisor.
Daniel Schiff	Assistant Professor in Political Science and Co-director of Governance and Responsible AI Lab, Purdue University. dschiff@purdue.edu. Postdoctoral Advisor.